

JFrog

DevSecOps / Software Supply Chain Security · Sunnyvale, CA · NASDAQ: FROG

The CMO who personally built the Udemy-McLaren partnership now runs marketing at JFrog - a profitable, cash-rich public company - and the software-supply-chain-security slot on the F1 grid is still completely empty.

86

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

McLaren

ACTION HORIZON

4-6 WKS

THE CASE

On 5 January 2026 JFrog appointed Genefa Murphy as Chief Marketing Officer for what it explicitly framed as its 'next growth phase' in AI-driven software supply chain management. Murphy is the decisive signal in this brief: at Udemy she personally architected the multi-series McLaren Racing partnership spanning Formula 1, IndyCar, NEOM McLaren Formula E and Extreme E. She is therefore not a cold prospect who must be educated on the value of motorsport - she is a proven, repeat motorsport-sponsorship buyer who has already done this exact deal once, and she now controls the brand budget of a company with \$531.8M revenue (+24% YoY), \$704.4M of cash and \$142.3M of free cash flow. The strategic gap is just as compelling as the relationship: while Confluent (data streaming) sits on the Williams livery, no software-supply-chain-security brand exists anywhere on the F1 grid. JFrog's category - the integrity and security of the code that ships software - is the single largest piece of uncontested enterprise whitespace in the paddock, and Murphy's own positioning language maps onto F1 almost word-for-word.

WHY NOW

Three clocks are running simultaneously. First, Murphy is roughly five months into a mandate her own company has branded a growth-phase reset - the precise window in which a new CMO defines the multi-year brand-investment agenda and shapes the next fiscal year's budget, before priorities harden. Second, because she has already delivered an F1/FE programme, the usual internal objection - 'does motorsport actually work for a B2B audience?' - is pre-answered by her personal track record, collapsing the normal 12-18 month education cycle to near zero. Third, the category whitespace is a depreciating asset: the moment a DevSecOps rival (Sonatype, Snyk or GitLab) plants a flag, JFrog's first-mover narrative is gone and the conversation becomes a defensive one. Moving in the next 4-6 weeks captures all three.

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

McLaren	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Williams	TAKEN	data platform / storage, identity & access security
Red Bull Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Aston Martin	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
EXEC MIGRATION CATEGORY WHITESPACE NEW LEADERSHIP FUNDING EVENT DISCOVERY: SEEDED		

WHY MCLAREN

McLaren is the warm, high-probability path. Murphy already knows the McLaren commercial organisation intimately from negotiating and activating the Udemy partnership, so an introduction is a re-engagement rather than a cold pitch, and McLaren's technology-forward, precision-engineering brand identity is the closest cultural mirror on the grid to JFrog's 'secure software, shipped fast' promise. If McLaren's relevant inventory is constrained, Aston Martin is the strong fallback: it carries premium enterprise gravitas, its hospitality audience skews to exactly the CISO and CTO buyers JFrog sells to, and its technology-partner roster leaves the DevSecOps slot open. Either team lets JFrog tell a 'from first commit to chequered flag' supply-chain-integrity story in front of the right room.

VALUE TO MCLAREN — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - a genuine two-way technical partnership, not branding alone. A modern F1 team operates a sprawling internal software estate: aerodynamic and strategy simulation, real-time race-systems code, telemetry pipelines and hundreds of engineers shipping builds every week. That is, by definition, a software supply chain - and securing and managing it is exactly what JFrog's platform does (artifact management, binary lifecycle, security scanning across the dev pipeline). A deal can therefore be structured around a real integration into the team's engineering workflow, giving McLaren an authentic 'official software supply chain partner' story it can stand behind technically, plus a credible R&D narrative, plus enterprise hospitality where JFrog's own buyers already gather on race weekends. The team gains tooling and a reference customer; JFrog gains a live proof point and a stage.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Recommended entry: Official Software Supply Chain Partner tier on McLaren (Aston Martin as fallback). MINIMUM THREE YEARS at an estimated \$3-5M/yr, calibrated to JFrog's \$531.8M revenue base and \$704M cash position. Scope: car and driver-suit branding in the software-supply-chain-security category, garage and B2B hospitality access, digital and content inventory aimed at an enterprise-IT audience, a working technical integration into the team's dev pipeline, and - critically - a category-exclusivity clause that blocks any DevSecOps rival from the team for the life of the contract.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Genefa Murphy, PhD
CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER, JFROG (APPOINTED 5 JAN 2026) - VERIFIED VIA JFROG PRESS ROOM

The single most important contact in this brief. As Chief Marketing & Content Officer at Udemy she personally built the multi-series McLaren Racing partnership (F1, IndyCar, NEOM McLaren Formula E, Extreme E). Previously CMO of Five9, SVP & CMO of Micro Focus, and Global VP Corporate Marketing at HPE. She is a repeat motorsport-sponsorship dealmaker who now owns JFrog's brand budget - approach her directly. Co-decision-maker: founder-CEO Shlomi Ben Haim for marquee spend.

OPENING ANGLE

"Genefa, you proved at Udemy that an F1 grid is a B2B pipeline channel, not a billboard. The software-supply-chain-security slot is still empty - JFrog can own the one category McLaren's other tech partners can't touch. Can we hold 25 minutes this week before a rival moves?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 18 / 20 CMO Genefa Murphy appointed Jan 5 2026 for a declared 'next growth phase'; FY2027 brand-budget planning is forming now, and a new CMO's first marquee investments are typically locked within the first two quarters.	CAPACITY 18 / 20 FY2025 revenue \$531.8M (+24%), \$704.4M cash, \$142.3M FCF, NDR 118%. A \$3-5M/yr deal is roughly 0.1% of revenue - immaterial to the balance sheet.	BRAND FIT 19 / 20 No software-supply-chain-security brand is anywhere on the F1 grid (Confluent = data streaming on Williams). JFrog can OWN the category outright, and Murphy's public thesis - 'trust, control and discipline at velocity' - is almost a motorsport tagline already.	URGENCY 15 / 20 Direct rivals Sonatype and Snyk are circling the same whitespace; whoever signs first locks category exclusivity for three years and forces the others onto rival teams.	OPS FIT 16 / 20 MODE A: an F1 team ships thousands of software builds a season across simulation, strategy and car systems - that is a literal software supply chain, so JFrog earns a genuine in-garage technical-partner role, not a sticker.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

BUDGET CYCLE LAG A discretionary brand-sponsorship line may not be formally approved until the FY2027 cycle. **Counter:** Frame it as a founder-level category land-grab rather than a marketing line item, and offer a short-form LOI to hold category exclusivity now while the budget formalises.

FOUNDER ALIGNMENT Founder-CEO Shlomi Ben Haim is hands-on; a marquee spend needs his explicit buy-in. **Counter:** Position trust and security - JFrog's core message - as a CEO-level brand story, and bring Ben Haim into the room alongside Murphy early.

B2B SKEPTICISM Investors may question motorsport spend at a company at a profitability inflection point. **Counter:** Murphy's Udemy-McLaren results are the proof case; lead with measured B2B pipeline and account-based outcomes, not impressions or reach.

SOURCES

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